

THE CALENDAR

A calendar is not a list of commitments, it is where your priority becomes visible to you.

How a leader should lay out their own week.

THE QUESTION OF THIS PIECE

Show me your last week.

THE CASCADE

The week other people build.



WHAT YOU SEE

You leave the calendar open for whoever needs you...



THE MECHANISM

...it gets filled by other people's requests...



THE CONSEQUENCE

...and what only you can do waits until after hours.

Whoever does not reserve their own time works all week on someone else's priority.

THE FORK

Every hour of yours falls into one of these.

WHERE THE HOUR GOES

01

Are you designing the path? That is direction.

02

Are you with people, developing them? That is development.

03

Are you resolving what only you resolve? That is decision.

Whatever falls into none of the three deserves a hard question.

THE METHOD

The week in four blocks.

01 **DIRECTION**

half a day a week, priority, plan and route review

02 **DEVELOPMENT**

fixed time with the team, one to ones and feedback

03 **DECISION**

short daily blocks for what only you can decide

04 **EMPTY**

the margin that absorbs surprises without felling the other three

Without the fourth block, any surprise destroys the whole week.

IN PRACTICE, IN ORDER

Four choices that reorganize the week.

01 • DIRECTION

Direction on Monday morning.

before the week starts asking things of you

02 •
DEVELOPMENT

One to ones on fixed days.

moving a 1:1 is the fastest way to say it does not matter

03 • DECISION

Two short windows a day.

concentrate decisions instead of being interrupted all day

04 • EMPTY

Twenty percent blank.

it is not idleness, it is the margin that keeps the rest alive

TWO MODELS

A firefighter's calendar or a leader's.

THE COMMON MODEL

Firefighter

Full of other people's meetings

Zero planning time

A 1:1 postponed for three weeks

No white space at all

THE DESIGNED MODEL

Leader

Blocks reserved before anything else

Direction protected every week

One to ones on a fixed day

Margin for the unexpected

MISTAKE AND CONSEQUENCE

Three silent time thieves.

01 **Accepting every invitation with no agenda.**

- a meeting with no agenda is time donated with nothing in return.

02 **Reserving time for decisions that should have an owner.**

- if you decide everything, your calendar will never fit.

03 **Leaving the door open all the time.**

- total availability means zero depth.

| Every block you do not reserve, someone reserves for you.

THE CHAIN

The calendar screenshot test.

01

Open last week and color in every commitment.



02

One color for direction, development, decision and empty.



03

The missing color is your leadership deficit.



WHERE LEADERSHIP STEPS IN

Usually two are missing, direction and empty. And the two explain each other.

RUN IT THIS WAY NEXT TIME

Thirty minutes to take the week back.

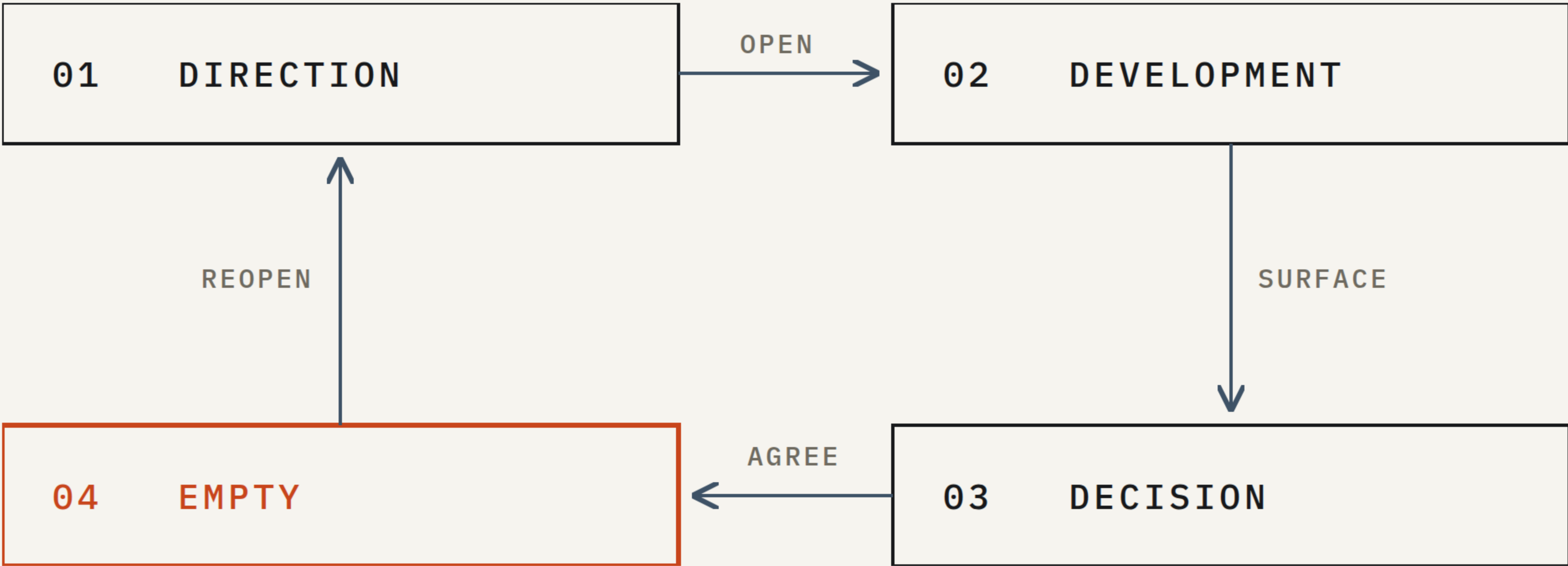
▣ STEP 01 Color in last week with the four colors. the picture appears fast, and it usually stings	▣ STEP 02 Block the direction slot before anything else. Monday morning, recurring, with yourself	■ STEP 03 Leave two blank blocks in next week. and resist the temptation to fill them on Tuesday
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A full calendar is not a sign of importance, it is a sign of no choices made.

THE MODEL THAT STICKS

The Week in Four Blocks, a loop and not a list.



Either you run your calendar, or it gets filled by other people's urgency.

SAVE THIS FOR LATER
next time you plan your week.

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